

User 3 Empathy Research Interview

- When you have a flare-up, how do you try to "trace back" what caused it?

I rely on memory, or ask my spouse. Use my FitBit to look at sleep patterns

- What do you find frustrating about your current tracking method, or if you don't track your condition, why?

I don't track. I haven't found a tracker for Hashimoto Disease that is free and also works accurately. I downloaded HashiHeal but there were lots of problems with that app. Others I've found aren't free. It's too much work to journal.

- What kind of data would you like to log? (e.g., stress, symptoms, meds, sleep, mood, diet, menstrual cycle, illness, exercise)

A symptom tracker including all the main ones and a place for "other" that I could free write anything additional. Sleep, yes and maybe even have it sync with Fitbit so I don't have to manually enter. Diet, yes and it would somehow need to compare or create a side by side view of how all these things correlate with or as a result of each other. All of the other things too, yes. And labs!

- How do you feel about getting reminders to track data?

It would help me to remember. I forget things easily when I'm in a flare up.

- How do you feel about tracking your Hashimoto Disease? (Anxious, motivated, frustrated, empowered, overwhelmed, etc.)

Firstly, frustrated that I have to or need to. Beyond that, at times overwhelmed but mostly motivated and empowered because of the results I see in improving my health. It would be great to somehow be able to trend symptoms as they relate to diet, exercise, sleep, stress, etc. Right now I would have to look at Sleep in Fitbit, exercise on either Fitbit or Planet Fitness or even Noom. I would have to look

at Noom or MyFitnessPal for tracking diet. Noom or Calm for stress tracking. You see? It's too much work and too hard to see any correlation to symptoms when I have to use so many things and open so many apps. Which is why I've not managed to keep up in using any of those apps and rely on memory to "trace back" when a flare up happens.

- What would help you feel more supported or less isolated?

Everything in one app. Graphs to show trends? Maybe something like you see when you look at labs in MyChart, a graph with dates and results as well as a list. Kind of like Zillow or Ticketmaster where you can look at a map or a list.

- What, if anything, would make it easy to use the app every day?

User friendly. Check boxes (don't forget an other place though if possible). Motivational or informational quotes when it opens. Personalized maybe and directly related to health and Hashi.

- What would deter you from using the app?

If it didn't meet my needs by tracking all the data I needed, choices for whether I want notifications and what kind of how often.

- How comfortable do you feel storing your health data in an app like this?

I don't know. I'm ok with it. I open all the other apps and store in them. Not sure what's different.

- If you could tell the person designing this app one thing to make it truly helpful for people with Hashimoto's, what would you say?

Sometimes, things are overwhelming for us even when the day is quite underwhelming. Doing one more thing seems intimidating when in a flare up. If it's not simple for the user then I'm not sure about using long term. I have tracked migraines before in apps but the ease and difficulty made me stop. Aesthetically pleasing would be great, too.

